

AN INQUIRY, FROM INSIDE THE THING ITSELF

The nature of nature.

What is the world, that it should be like this — and never once hold still?

ON THE NATURE OF NATURE

Nature is not a collection of things. It is the way things happen.

We name the tree, the river, the storm — and mistake the names for the world. But the tree is a slow fire, the river a standing wave, the storm a knot that unties itself.

Every noun in nature is a verb caught mid-motion.

ON THE NATURE OF NATURE
PHYSIS • THE FIRST WORD FOR NATURE

The Greeks heard nature as a verb before it was ever a noun.

physis

From *phúō*, "to grow, to bring forth" —
nature named not the things, but their way of
coming to be.

The forest keeps nothing, and loses nothing.

Seed

A life begins from the ruin
of the one before it.



Growth

It takes sun, rain, and soil,
and stands them up as
wood.



Death

The standing life falls; the
form it held is done.



Decay

Fungus and worm return
it to the ground, and feed
the seed.



ON THE NATURE OF NATURE

Nature wears two faces — the making, and the made.

NATURA NATURANS

The ceaseless process of becoming — nature as the verb, never finished, never still.



NATURA NATURATA

The forms it has thrown up — nature as the noun, every one of them on loan and called back.

“

No man ever steps in the same river twice — for it is not the same river, and he is not the same man.

”

Heraclitus, on a world that is only ever flowing

Nature signs everything it makes with the same four marks.

Self-similarity

The branch repeats the tree; the river's delta repeats the leaf's vein.

Cycles

Nothing is ever spent — only moved, and moved again, and returned.

Emergence

The whole keeps a property no single part was ever holding.

Impermanence

Every form is a loan against time, and time always collects.

ON THE NATURE OF NATURE

To understand nature is to stop hunting for the noun.

The question was never "what things is the world made of?" It was "what is the world doing?" — and the answer, everywhere you look, is the same: becoming, and becoming again.

The river is the flowing. The forest is the turning. You are the living, not the thing that lives.

THE VERB WAS NEVER SOMETHING YOU WATCH. IT IS SOMETHING YOU ARE.

**You are not a thing in
nature. You are nature,
naturing.**